

Fifth Sunday After Pentecost

Dominica Quinta Post Pentecosten

TLM propers: reconciliation before sacrifice

Proper	TLM text / reference	Scriptural axis	Fathers and saints	Connection
Introit	<i>Exaudi, Domine, vocem meam</i> (Ps. 26)	Seeking the saving God	St. Augustine on Psalm 26; St. Anselm on desire for God	The entrance cry is personal and urgent: prayer seeks the face that makes peace possible.
Collect	Love God in all things and above all things	Ordered charity	St. Augustine, <i>De doctrina christiana</i> I; St. Bernard, <i>On Loving God</i>	The collect gives the key: all reconciliation depends on loving God above every injury.
Epistle	1 Pet. 3:8-15	Unity, compassion, blessing, peace	St. Cyprian on unity; St. John Climacus on meekness	Peter turns holiness into a social form: bless, seek peace, sanctify Christ in the heart.
Gospel	Matt. 5:20-24	Leave the gift; be reconciled	St. John Chrysostom on Matthew; St. Jerome on the Sermon on the Mount	Sacrifice cannot bypass charity. The altar itself sends the worshipper toward the offended brother.
Offertory	<i>Benedicam Dominum... providebam Deum</i> (Ps. 15)	God before the eyes	St. Ignatius of Antioch on unity around the altar	Offering becomes true when the heart stands before God without cherished resentment.
Communion	<i>Unam petii a Domino</i> (Ps. 26)	Dwelling in the house of the Lord	St. Augustine on the one desire	The one thing sought purifies many divided passions.

Four Senses of Scripture

Thread	Synthesis
Literal	Matthew 5 commands reconciliation before offering the gift at the altar; 1 Peter commands unity, compassion, blessing, and the pursuit of peace.
Allegorical	The altar points to Christ's sacrifice and the Church's Eucharistic offering, where fractured charity contradicts the sacrament of unity.
Moral	The worshipper must leave resentment, contempt, and evasive delay, then seek peace in the concrete form appropriate to the offense.

Anagogical

Reconciliation before the altar prepares the soul for the peace of the heavenly temple, where no hatred can enter the vision of God.

Homily Sketch

Proposition. The altar does not permit unreconciled hatred to masquerade as worship. Christ sends the worshipper from the gift to the brother and back again.

Opening movement. The Introit cries, *Exaudi, Domine*. But the Gospel asks whether the Lord will hear a prayer offered over a cherished quarrel. The problem is not that worship is unimportant; it is so important that it demands truth.

Doctrinal center. The Collect asks for love of God in all things and above all things. This is the only love strong enough to relativize anger, injury, and the desire to win.

Moral turn. The Epistle's command to bless rather than repay evil is the practical form of the Gospel's altar command. Reconciliation is not sentiment; it is obedience before sacrifice.

Exegetical Notes

- Matthew 5 moves from the external act of murder to anger, contempt, and unreconciled memory.
- Christ says, "if thy brother hath anything against thee." The initiative belongs to the worshipper even when pride prefers delay.
- The altar image gives urgency: even a sacred act pauses before the demand of charity.

Witness	Short text	Homiletic use
St. John Chrysostom	Be reconciled so the work may not remain imperfect.	Use this to show that unreconciled worship is unfinished worship.
St. Gregory the Great	Strife throws away what should aid remission.	This gives a sharp warning without weakening the mercy of confession.
St. Jerome	The text says the brother has something against you.	Preach initiative: do not wait for the other person to make peace easy.
St. Cyprian	Unity belongs to the sacrifice of the Church.	Connect private resentment to ecclesial communion.

Thread	Synthesis
Altar and brother	This Sunday makes reconciliation liturgical. The movement is not from worship to ethics as an afterthought; ethics is demanded by the altar.
Interior and communal peace	The Epistle's humility and the Gospel's reconciliation reveal that peace starts in the sanctified heart and becomes ecclesial communion.
Justice and mercy	Christ does not abolish justice; he deepens it from external nonviolence to purified memory, speech, and intention.
One desire	The Communion's <i>Unam petii</i> gathers the scattered soul. The person who wants one thing can surrender the many claims of resentment.
Prayer focus	Before offering prayer, name one relationship needing repair and take the first truthful step toward peace.

Preaching Applications

- Distinguish reconciliation from pretending no wrong occurred; truth and charity must meet.
- Ask hearers to examine contemptuous speech, not only obvious anger.
- Recommend a concrete step: apology, restitution, intercessory prayer, or counsel where direct contact would be imprudent.

Primary References

- Missale Romanum 1962, *Dominica Quinta post Pentecosten*.
- Suggested patristic study: Chrysostom on Matthew 5; Cyprian, On the Unity of the Catholic Church; Augustine on Psalm 26.

Full Patristic and Saintly Texts

- St. John Chrysostom, in the *Catena Aurea* on Matthew 5: “If love alone is not enough to induce us to be reconciled to our neighbour, the desire that our work should not remain imperfect, and especially in the holy place, should induce us.”
- St. Gregory the Great, in the *Catena Aurea* on Matthew 5: “He is not willing to accept sacrifice at the hands of those who are at variance.”
- St. Jerome, in the *Catena Aurea* on Matthew 5: “It is not, If thou hast ought against thy brother; but, If thy brother has ought against thee.”